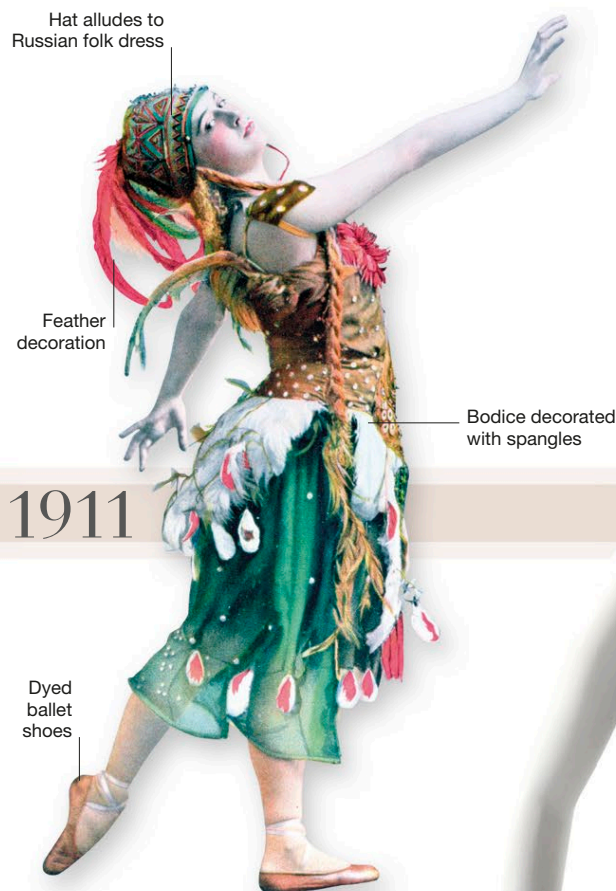




The Firebird Tamara Platnovna Karsavina danced the title role in Igor Stravinsky's ballet *The Firebird*, a huge success when launched in Paris in 1911. The costume is by Léon Bakst, who worked on many Ballets Russes productions.



Fancy dress In 1911 Paul Poiret organized a fancy dress party with the theme "The One Thousand and Second Night" to promote his new designs. This opulent creation foreshadowing the use of "lampshade" overskirts was worn that evening.



Opera coat Attributed to Poiret, this garment shows a range of influences, both in cut and finish. The loose wrap-over shape and wide sleeves resemble a kimono, while the embroidery is inspired by Middle Eastern architecture.



Tutankhamun After the discovery of the Pharaoh's tomb in 1922, elements that were believed to be part of Egypt's culture appeared in dress and jewellery. Poiret's afternoon dress is embroidered with hieroglyphic motifs.



Renaissance Italian designer Maria Gallenga is often compared with Venetian-based Fortuny over her choice of colours, fabrics, and techniques. Hand-stencilled velvets reminiscent of Renaissance fabrics were made into a dress shape evocative of the Middle Ages.